



DOCUMENTATION

# Documentation Guide.

Voice, doc profiles, and how to write & format Stratos Edge materials.

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# Voice.

Calm, declarative, anti-hype. Stratos Edge talks like a grown-up advisor to boards and C-suites in regulated industries. Not a vendor pitching.

## THE FIVE RULES

### 1 Statements, not claims.

Every sentence should read like something true, not something being argued. "Most AI initiatives fail" works. "We help you avoid failure!" does not.

### 2 Strategy before technology.

This is the thesis. Every doc should reinforce that getting AI right is a strategy problem first. "Stop buying AI tools. Start building AI capability."

### 3 Short and declarative beats long and qualified.

Three short sentences beat one comma-laden one. The homepage's strongest lines are fragments: "We walk alongside you." / "These aren't technology failures. They're strategy failures."

### 4 No hype words.

Avoid: cutting-edge, revolutionary, transformative (as marketing adjective), best-in-class, world-class, unleash, supercharge, AI-powered (as a brag), seamless, robust, leverage (verb), synergy, paradigm. If a word would fit on a 2017 SaaS sales deck, cut it.

### 5 One coral period per moment.

In writing terms: don't end every paragraph with a punchy declaration. Save the big declarative finish for the moment that actually deserves it.

# Sound of the brand.

These are the homepage's actual voice samples. Match this register, not "marketing voice."

*"AI advisory for organizations where getting it wrong isn't an option."*

*"What we help you do."*

*"We walk alongside you."*

*"FlightPlan™ is how we do it."*

*"However far along you are, you leave more confident in what's next."*

*"These aren't technology failures. They're strategy failures — and they're preventable."*

*"Stop buying AI tools. Start building AI capability."*

*"No pitch deck. No pressure. Just a conversation."*

## Vocabulary

### USE

advisor, advisory, vendor-neutral, mid-market, regulated industries, board-ready, readiness, strategy, capability, ecosystem, partner, walk alongside, no cost to you.

### AVOID

solutions provider (we're an advisor), AI-powered (we don't build AI), cutting-edge, disrupt, game-changer, deep dive, dive in (any dive metaphor), wheelhouse, circle back.

## Capitalization

- **FlightPlan™** — camelCase, trademark on first major use per doc.
- **Stratos Edge** — two words, both capitalized.
- Industries are lowercase in body text ("healthcare," "financial services") unless leading a heading.

## Headline style

- End with a coral period (visually) — see the Brand Guide.
- Sentence case, not Title Case. "Who's behind it" not "Who's Behind It."
- Most homepage headlines are 2–6 words. Match that.
- Don't pose questions you immediately answer — make the statement instead.

## Tense and person

- "We" for the company. Never "I" in a document.

- Present tense for what Stratos does. Past for what's happened. Future tense should be rare.

# Document profiles.

Two profiles cover essentially all Stratos documents. Pick by intent, not by audience.

THE DEFAULT

## Stratos Simple.

*Clean, light, Stratos-identified. Used for almost everything.*

Most documents are this. Light-backgrounded, Stratos-identified, professionally formatted, easy to read. Not selling anything. Used for confirmations, intro letters, summary docs, internal memos, working notes, explainers, short briefs.

VISUAL RECIPE

- Background: #FFFFFF (default) or #F2F0E9 (warm editorial)
- Small STRATOS | EDGE wordmark, top of first page, left-aligned
- Body: Lora 16–18pt, line-height 1.55–1.7, INK #04242D
- Section headings: Work Sans 400, INK, with the coral period
- Footer: single line of small Lora at MUTED — date, page number, contextual identifier

WHAT THIS PROFILE IS NOT

- No hero cover page. Open straight to the document.
- No accent bar, no stat strips, no numbered insight blocks. Those are Playbook moves.
- No dark teal sections.
- No coral-gradient buttons. CTAs are a single line of coral-period text.

WORDING VARIANTS (STYLING IDENTICAL, FOOTER COPY IS THE ONLY VARIABLE)

| USE                | FOOTER LINE                               |
|--------------------|-------------------------------------------|
| Internal-facing    | Stratos Edge · Internal · {date}          |
| Client / recipient | Stratos Edge · {date} or · stratosedge.ai |
| Public-facing      | © 2026 Stratos Edge LLC · stratosedge.ai  |

## Stratos Playbook.

*Full marketing treatment. Borrows the FlightPlan deliverable language.*

For documents doing real persuasive work: sales playbooks, lead magnets, the agent program opportunity doc, methodology overviews, industry briefs. Borrows the FlightPlan deliverable design language — colorized, sectioned, editorial, dramatic.

### USE SPARINGLY

It's the equivalent of a Stratos hero band — high impact when used, exhausting if everything looks like this.

### VISUAL RECIPE

- **Cover page** — full-bleed dark teal #04242D . Small coral eyebrow at top. Large Lora 400 hero title, white, letter-spacing -0.02em . Subtitle in Lora at rgba(245,245,247,0.65) . Wordmark white at bottom corner.
- **Section dividers** — full-bleed dark teal bands between sections, mirroring FlightPlan. Coral eyebrow + large Lora title in white. 2–4 per doc, not on every section.
- **Body sections** — alternate #FFFFFF and #F8F8F8 (occasionally #F2F0E9 for editorial). Work Sans 400 headings with coral period. Lora body.
- **Components available** — accent bar under cover title, eyebrow labels above sections, stat strips, pull quotes, numbered insight blocks. Use 1–2 component types per doc — not all of them.
- **CTA** — end with a single coral-gradient button and a one-line action statement.
- **Footer on body pages** — small Work Sans line, Stratos Edge · stratosedge.ai · page N . Substitute "Internal" for internal-only playbooks. Don't use "Confidential" unless the document genuinely warrants it.

### WHEN TO CHOOSE PLAYBOOK OVER SIMPLE

- The reader is supposed to feel something (interest, urgency, conviction) by the end.
- The doc is going to be printed, screenshotted, or shared as a marketing artifact.
- The doc is making an argument, not delivering information.

Everything else is Simple.

# Components.

Reusable visual elements that appear inside documents. All optional — pick what serves the content.

## Pull quote

A short, bold statement that interrupts body flow. One per major section, max two per Playbook doc.

*They just started. And they started with a plan.*

4pt CORAL left border · CREAM or OFFWHITE bg · Lora 400 italic, ~15pt, INK

## Emphasis line

A two-line statement where the second line carries the punch.

The real problem isn't AI.  
**It's the plan.**

Work Sans 300 throughout, punch phrase in coral at weight 500

## Stat strip

Horizontal row of 2–4 large numbers with small labels beneath. Anchors an argument with data.

95%

OF AI PILOTS FAIL

70%

ARE GOVERNANCE

97%

USES AI POORLY

Numbers: Work Sans 200, ~32pt, CORAL · Labels: Work Sans 500, ~7pt UPPERCASE

## Numbered insight block

A numbered argument or principle, with the number as a large, low-opacity background mark. Playbook-only.

01

### Section title goes here.

Body text follows. Used for numbered arguments in Playbook docs (e.g., "Three things every AI strategy needs").



## Accent bar

Short coral gradient bar — divider, or underline beneath a cover title.



44pt × 3pt · radius 2pt · `linear-gradient(135deg, #FF6B4A, #FF8A6B)`

# Layout.

## Page geometry

- US Letter (8.5 × 11 in) for PDFs
- Horizontal margins: 0.7in (Playbook) or 0.85in (Simple — more generous, reads more editorial)
- First-page top padding: 0.55in (Playbook cover) or 0.85in (Simple)
- Footer: absolute-positioned, 0.5in above edge; 1pt HAIRLINE rule above on Simple, none on Playbook dark sections

## On screen (HTML rendering of a doc)

- max-width: 760px for body-text sections (matches About / FAQ pattern)
- max-width: 1280px for hero sections, photos, grids (matches Homepage)
- Horizontal padding: px-6 md:px-12 lg:px-16 xl:px-24
- Section padding: clamp(5rem, 10vh, 7rem) Simple · clamp(6rem, 12vh, 8rem) Playbook hero

# Choosing a profile.

| DOCUMENT                            | PROFILE           |
|-------------------------------------|-------------------|
| Email confirmation page             | Simple            |
| Intro letter to a prospect          | Simple            |
| Summary of a discovery conversation | Simple            |
| Working memo to the team            | Simple (internal) |
| Short explainer for a recipient     | Simple            |
| Brand guide / docs (like this file) | Simple            |
| Agent program overview PDF          | Playbook          |
| Sales Playbook                      | Playbook          |
| Lead magnet / 4 Decisions PDF       | Playbook          |
| LinkedIn Playbook                   | Playbook          |

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FlightPlan deliverable

Its own thing (Playbook patterns at max intensity)

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**WHEN IN DOUBT**

**Simple.** It's almost always the right call. Playbook is the exception.

## What this guide is not.

- **Not a visual identity reference.** For palette, fonts, marks — see the Brand Guide.
  - **Not a tone for spoken communication.** Jeff's emails and Micah's calls are warmer and more personal than written brand voice should be. This guide is for documents.
  - **Not legal / regulatory copy guidance.** Terms of service, privacy policy, the Agent Program Terms use legal voice (precise, comprehensive, slightly stiff). That's correct for those documents — a different genre, not a Stratos brand exception.
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